CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 13–17: **Saving the Gharial, The Elephant and the Tragopan, That Little Square Box, Marshlands, The Three Caskets** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which statement is best supported by the jaw-clap observation? 1

(a) Gharials are silent
(b) Male gharials communicate with sound and display
(c) Only females are noisy
(d) Gharials cannot hear

2. If humans are 'neither good nor bad but both', the poem's appeal is best aimed at: 1

(a) their better side **(b)** the trout
(c) the tragopan alone **(d)** the animals

3. The expression 'letting it off' is an example of: 1

(a) rhyme **(b)** ambiguity **(c)** metaphor **(d)** alliteration

4. The simile 'like large cups of gold' mainly creates a feeling of: 1

(a) fear **(b)** great wealth
(c) unexpected beauty in a gloomy place **(d)** anger

5. The skull in the gold casket is a symbol of: 1

(a) victory **(b)** Portia's love
(c) great wealth **(d)** death that ends worldly show

6. The author's tone while describing parental care is mostly: 1

(a) bored **(b)** mocking
(c) warm and admiring **(d)** fearful

7. The poet gives no direct moral at the end. This makes the reader: 1

(a) forget the poem **(b)** laugh
(c) ignore the message **(d)** work out the lesson themselves

8. The countdown in the lifeboat is similar to: 1

(a) a cooking show
(b) scenes in thrillers where a bomb is about to explode
(c) a football match
(d) a school assembly

9. The word 'creep' used for vapours suggests they move: 1

(a) swiftly **(b)** violently
(c) slowly and stealthily **(d)** joyfully

10. The story is mainly an example of: 1

(a) a comic farce **(b)** a mystery
(c) a war story **(d)** a lesson on judging by worth, not show

11. The sentence 'Only two survived' creates a tone of: 1

(a) celebration **(b)** anger **(c)** disappointment **(d)** humour

12. Change to the passive: 'Humans destroy forests.' 1

(a) Forests destroyed by humans. **(b)** Forests are destroying humans.
(c) Forests are destroyed by humans. **(d)** Humans are destroyed by forests.

13. Why does the narrator imagine the lives of all the passengers at risk? 1

(a) it makes his fear and his duty to speak seem more urgent
(b) it proves the men are sailors
(c) it shows he is a doctor
(d) it explains the voyage

14. 'Hushed lie the sedges' uses inversion. The normal order would be: 1

(a) Hushed the sedges lie they **(b)** The hushed lie sedges
(c) Lie hushed sedges the **(d)** The sedges lie hushed

15. Choose the correct reported speech: Morocco said, 'I shall choose gold.' 1

(a) Morocco said he will chose gold. **(b)** Morocco said that he would choose gold.
(c) Morocco says he would chose gold. **(d)** Morocco said that I shall choose gold.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Use 'camouflage' in a sentence of your own and explain how it fits the chapter. 2

17. Use 'short-sighted' in a sentence about the trout. 2

18. How does the author make the ending comic? 2

19. How do the first and last couplets contrast? 2

20. What can we infer about Morocco from his request about his complexion? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Explain what each suitor would have learnt from his casket. 3

22. Why is captive breeding useful yet not sufficient? 3

23. How does personification help the poet convey his message? 3

24. Explain the difference between suspense and surprise in this story. 3

OR

How does the poet make silence seem an actual space? 3

25. Examine the contrast between Morocco's and Arragon's characters. 3

OR

Discuss the role of international cooperation shown in the chapter. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Describe a place near you at sunset in a poem or paragraph using at least two figures of speech. 5

OR

Do you agree that the test is fair to Portia? Support your view. 5

27. Analyse the author's purpose and her methods of persuasion. 5

OR

Critically appreciate 'The Elephant and the Tragopan'. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND